

Party LAN Style

Put a lot of crazed geeks with their killer wares in one place, lock 'em up, plug them into one huge LAN, and shout at the top of your voice, "Let the games begin!"

"Dapro Kill na re!
"Arrey Stop
Snipering Da"
"Shut up you
camping FAG!"

It's 5.30 in the morning, that fragile state between coma and hyperactivity, when a bunch of crazed gamers are shouting obscenities in a deathmatch which has as much aggression offline as online. Maybe it's the round of coffee, maybe it's the adrenaline rush of being in their gaming elements—whatever the reason be, they are busy killing themselves.

Playing with real opponents is a completely different ballgame. To kick ass or to get your ass kicked is a far more personal gaming experience. There's no doubt which is better: fragging real people or bots. Teamplay and deathmatch, clans and guilds, they all make fragging a much more intimate indulgence, for where else can you relish in smack talk, and savour the expression of victory by screaming, "WHO'S YOUR DADDY?"

Anyone who has played a game in a LAN environment knows that playing over the Net can never really match the adrenaline rush that a LAN circuit produces. For those who are yet to be initiated into the underworld of gaming, LAN Parties are one of the most interesting phenomena to pop up in recent years.

The premise of a LAN Party is simple. Take multiple computers, wire them up, and have people playing games against or with each other. Proceed to gib your opponents in marathon gaming sessions that last for days. Of course, other things such as adequate electrical power, food, and an appetite for gore are nice to have, but by no means a necessity.

There are small house parties, where groups of friends will get together to play a few games. Then there are commercial LAN parties like WasteLan and Quake-Con that draw crowds of over 2,000 people with all-night competitions, tournaments, food, drink, and all the



other regular stuff that smaller parties usually have.

Online gaming vs LAN gaming

You will often have enough time to catch a rerun of *Friends* while using a

